India matters because it not only symbolizes good governance; its digital public infrastructure has a larger relevance to the world.

Developed nations may gladly recognize such progress in a polity that they have long viewed as an underperformer. It certainly opens up new avenues of collaboration. But developing countries see it as experiences that are directly applicable to them, especially when they are executed on such a large canvas.

That India has now become a laboratory, a training ground, a driver of innovation and invention as well as a field of demonstration heightens its relevance. The Covid pandemic brought out its contribution as the pharmacy of the world. Its digital skill and start-ups are generating a steady stream of technologies and services. Its impact on business outcomes is as strong as on public delivery. In fact, key global challenges like climate action are likely to be more effectively addressed if India emerges as an exemplar. Its leapfrogging potential will make a real difference when realized. Similarly, the rapid progress of Make in India in different domains can validate how much more can be made with the world and for the world. The scale, scope and competitiveness that we can bring to bear have all the markings of an additional engine of growth. India matters both as an inspiration and as a key factor in decentralized globalization.

SIGNIFICANCE OF ITS TALENT

The last few years have seen a surge in India’s self-confidence. A generation that is surer of itself naturally has higher aspirations. For talent to be translated into capabilities, it is necessary to create the mechanisms, institutions and practices. Large nations, in particular, require deep strengths. If there has been a major shortcoming in India’s post-1991 performance, it has been in the inadequacy of that level of capabilities. Contentment with corporate profitability overrode any commitment to create resilient domestic supply chains. That growth was insufficiently reflected in expansion of employment spoke for itself. Reform itself was conceptualized in narrow terms to serve a limited constituency.

As the nation now shifts gears to upgrade the human resources chain as well as step up manufacturing and innovation, a new range of prospects has opened up, from established domains like chemicals and textiles to contemporary ones like electronic hardware, semiconductors and